Ans. (d): The vast majority of large reefs created by corals in shallow waters (< 50 m water depth) and located within a tropical zone located between 30ºN and 30ºS latitude with a preferred temperature range of approximately 22º to 29º C. Coral reefs are often called the "tropical rainforests of the sea" for their astounding richness of life. So, statement (1) and (2) are correct.

- Coral reefs are the most diverse communities on the planet. These tropical marine communities occupy less than 1% of the ocean floor but are inhabited by at least 25% of all marine species. Scientists estimate that more than 25,000 described species from thirty-two of the world's thirty- three animal phyla live in reef habitats-four times the number of animal phyla found in tropical rain forests. So statement (3) is also correct.

84. With reference to the 'Global Alliance for Climate-Smart Agriculture (GACSA)', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. GACSA is outcome of the Climate Summit held in Paris in 2015.
2. Membership of GACSA does not create any binding obligations.
3. India was instrumental in the creation of GACSA.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The Global Alliance for Climate-Smart Agriculture (GACSA) was launched on 23 September 2014 at the UN Climate Summit. GACSA is an independent alliance governed by its members through a strategic committee and its Co-chairs. Since the 1 January, FAO is hosting the Facilitation unit of GACSA which is supported through a multi-donor trust fund.

GACSA is a voluntary alliance of partners dedicated to addressing the challenges facing food security and agriculture under a changing climate. In particular, the alliance has the objective of upscaling the climate-smart agriculture approach a concept which were originally developed by FAO.

GACSA's ambitious future is based upon supporting and inspiring action. Farmers, fisherman, foresters, and ranches are at the centre of this action and therefore, GACSA devoting its Annual Forum to showcasing climate-smart agriculture in action.

The forum will be a dynamic gathering, where the participants share solutions, discuss challenges, and build partnerships on climate- smart agriculture. Seeking out action-oriented state holders to come to both shares and learn at the GACSA annual forum.

85. The term "sixth mass extinction/sixth extinction" is often mentioned in the news in the context of the discussion of:

(a) Widespread monoculture practices in agriculture and large-scale commercial farming with indiscriminate use of chemicals in many parts of the world that may result in the loss of good native ecosystems.
(b) Fears of a possible collision of a meteorite with the Earth in the near future in the manner it happened 65 million years ago that caused the mass extinction of many species including those of dinosaurs.
(c) Large scale cultivation of genetically modified crops in many parts of the world and promoting their cultivation in other parts of the world which may cause the disappearance of good native crop plants and the loss of food biodiversity
(d) Mankind's over-exploitation/misuse of natural resources, fragmentation/loss of natural habitats, destruction of ecosystems, pollution and global climate change.

Ans. (d) : The term "sixth mass extinction/ sixth extinction in often referred to as the Holocene Extinction, which is the ongoing extinction event of species during the present Holocene epoch, mainly as a result of human activity.

- The five mass extinction that took place in the last 450 million years have led to the destruction of 70-95 percent of the species of plants, animals and microorganisms that existed earlier.
- These extinctions were caused by 'catastrophic' alterations to the environment, such as massive volcanic eruptions, depletion of oceanic oxygen or collision with an asteroid.
- A large number of extinctions spans numerous families of plants and animals, including mammals, birds, amphibians, reptiles and arthropods.
- The current extinction rate is approximately 100 extinctions per million per year, or 1000 times higher than natural background rates.

86. The Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE), a UN mechanism to assist countries transition towards greener and more inclusive economies, emerged at:

(a) The Earth Summit on Sustainable Development 2002, Johannesburg
(b) The United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development 2012, Rio de Janeiro
(c) The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change 2015, Paris
(d) The World Sustainable Development Summit 2016, New Delhi

Ans. (b): The partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE) was launched in 2013 as a response to the call at Rio+20 in 2012 in Rio de Janeiro to support those countries wishing to embark on greener and more inclusive growth trajectories. The PAGE seeks to put sustainability at the heart of economic policymaking. The partnership supports nations and regions in reframing economic policies and practices around sustainability to foster economic growth, create income and jobs, reduce poverty and inequality and strengthen the ecological foundations of their economies. PAGE is a direct response to the Rio+20 Declaration. The Future We want which called upon the United Nations System and the international community to provide assistance to interested countries in developing adopting and implementing green economy policies and strategies.

87. Why is a plant called Prosopis juliflora often mentioned in news?

(a) Its extract is widely used in cosmetics.
(b) It tends to reduce the biodiversity in the area in which it grows.
(c) Its extract is used in the synthesis of pesticides.
(d) None of the above

Ans. (b) : Prosopis juliflora is a shrub or small tree in the family Fabaceae a kind of mesquite. It is native to Mexico, South America and the Caribbean. It is a contributing factor to the continuing transmission of malaria, especially during dry periods when sugar sources from native plants are largely unavailable to mosquitoes.

This is not a big threat to the country's biodiversity but also has become a burden on the environment. This tree is scattered in around 12 states of the country. It has destroyed about 500 species of native plants. If it has not been eliminated on time, it will destroy the remaining bio-diversity of the country. Its roots are too deep which absorbs a lot of water also. It was brought to India in 1870.

- It was included forage, wood and environmental management.

88. "Momentum for Change : Climate Neutral Now" is an initiative launched by.

(a) The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
(b) The UNEP Secretariat
(c) The UNFCCC Secretariat
(d) The World Meteorological Organization

Ans. (c): The UNFCCC secretariat launched its Climate Neutral Now initiative in 2015. The following year, the secretariat launched a new pillar under its Momentum for change initiative focused on Climate Neutral Now as part of larger efforts to showcase successful climate action around the world.

89. In which one of the following States is Pakhui Wildlife Sanctuary located?

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Manipur
(c) Meghalaya (d) Nagaland

Ans. (a): Pakhui is a wildlife sanctuary and a dedicated Tiger Reserve (also known as the Pakke Tiger Reserve) in the district of East Kameng in Arunachal Pradesh. It has an area of over 860 square kilometers and is bordered by the kameng River and Pakke River, which are important sources of water for the animal and the irrigation of the vegetation. The Pakhui reserve is neighbour to the Nameri Tiger Reserve in Assam-making this area a true treasure trove in terms of these spectacular animals.

90. Consider the following statements:

1. The definition of "Critical Wildlife Habitat" is incorporated in the Forest Rights Act, 2006.
2. For the first time in India, Baigas have been given Habitat Rights.
3. Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change officially decides and declares Habitat Rights for Primitive and Vulnerable Tribal Groups in any part of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): The phrase 'critical wildlife habitat' is defined only in the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006. The statement is correct.

- In a bid to undo historical injustice meted out to primitive tribal communities living in central India, the government of Madhya Pradesh, for the first time, recognized the habitat rights of seven villages in Dindori district mostly inhabited by the Baigas. Statement (2) is correct.
- Under the act the District level committee shall answer that all particularly vulnerable Tribal Groups receive habitat rights, in consultation with the concerned traditional intuitions of particularly vulnerable Tribal Groups and their claims for habitat rights are filed before the concerned Gram Sabha.

Statement (3) is not correct.

91. With reference to organic farming in India, consider the following statements:

1. 'The National Programme for Organic Production' (NPOP) is operated under the guidelines and directions of the Union Ministry of Rural Development.
2. 'The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) functions as the Secretariat for the implemention of NPOP.
3. Sikkim has become India's first fully organic State.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Ministry of Commerce has implemented the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) since 2001. Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) functions as the secretariat for the implementation of the NPOP. Sikkim has become India's first fully organic state, in 2016 by implementing organic practices on around 75000 hectares of agricultural land.

So, correct answer is option (b).